

The first rule of Money Meal is that you don't talk about Money Meal.

Sorry, that's Fight Club.

(Though at my house there's often a fair amount of fighting, over dinner.)

Here are the real rules for making Money Meal the best night of your week:

1. Everyone pitches in

If your house is anything like mine, dinner is like feeding time at the zoo: it's something you rarely look forward to, it's over quickly and you're left with the mess.

But if your kids want to eat, they have to pitch in—peeling the potatoes, setting the table, clearing the table, stacking the dishwasher, wiping down the benches.

I call them *duties* (which is very different from paid jobs).

Everyone has a 'Dinner Duty' to do as part of putting dinner on the table, not just the parents. Not for money. It's the honourable thing to do.

2. It's payday!

A weekly Barefoot Money Meal provides the perfect anchor for your three-minute check of the Barefoot Scoreboard, and for paying your kids their weekly pocket money.

For maximum effect I recommend leaving payday to the end of the meal, to keep your kids interested.

(Quick note: This rule works like a charm in my house, but you may prefer to keep your three-minute weekly payday separate from mealtime. Up to you!)

3. Make it your new family tradition